

REQUEST FOR EMPANELMENT

Empanelment of Due Diligence Agencies / Experts

For startup commercial, financial, legal / compliance, governance, and related due diligence support for RTIH and its ecosystem

Issuing Entity	Ratan Tata Innovation Hub Amaravati Foundation (RTIH)
Document Ref No	RTIH-AMVT/RFE/2026/004
Issue Date	21 Apr 2026
Submission Mode	Single Google Form response with structured uploads
Application Window	Open on a rolling basis
Review Cycle	Applications will ordinarily be reviewed once every quarter
Empanelment Type	Non-exclusive; no work order guarantee

Table of Contents

1. Background and Purpose.....	3
2. Rolling Application and Review Cycle.....	3
3. Nature of Empanelment.....	3
4. Indicative Scope of Services.....	4
5. Eligibility Criteria.....	4
6. Information to be Submitted.....	4
7. Submission Structure and Method.....	5
8. Evaluation Approach.....	7
9. Optional Public Listing of Empanelled Firms.....	7
10. Key Terms & General Provisions.....	7
Annexure 1: Minimum Scope Inclusions for Mandatory Commercial Items	9
Annexure 2: Indicative Document Responsibility Matrix.....	11

1. Background and Purpose

Ratan Tata Innovation Hub Amaravati Foundation (RTIH) invites applications from eligible due diligence firms, CA / CS / legal advisory firms, multidisciplinary advisory LLPs / companies, and other legally eligible professional entities for empanelment on a non-exclusive basis to provide startup due diligence and related assessment support for RTIH and its ecosystem.

The empanelled panel is intended to support startup screening, funding support, scheme-linked recommendation, milestone-based disbursement, incubation or acceleration decisions, and other governance processes where structured due diligence inputs are considered necessary or useful.

2. Rolling Application and Review Cycle

Milestone	Date/ Remarks
Release of RFE	21 Apr 2026
Application Mode	Rolling / open call
Submission Channel	RTIH Google Form with structured uploads
Review Frequency	Applications will ordinarily be reviewed once every quarter
Review Cut-offs	RTIH may adopt quarterly cut-off dates for administrative convenience and may notify the current applicable cut-off on the website / Google Form / related communication
Clarifications	May be submitted on a rolling basis to proposals@rtih.co.in
Communication of Empanelment	RTIH may communicate empanelment outcomes after each review cycle or as otherwise determined
Applications received after a review cut-off	May be considered in the next review cycle

3. Nature of Empanelment

- The empanelment is non-exclusive.
- RTIH may empanel one or more firms / experts, including multidisciplinary or specialist providers.
- Assignments may be issued from time to time based on requirement, specialization, independence, responsiveness, timelines, past performance, and commercial reasonableness.
- RTIH may allocate integrated due diligence assignments or separate workstreams such as financial, commercial, legal / compliance, governance, or IP / technical review.
- Empanelment shall not guarantee any minimum number of assignments, minimum fee, or preferred status.

4. Indicative Scope of Services

- Commercial / business due diligence, including review of business model, market context, traction, customer evidence, partnerships, milestones, and use of funds.
- Financial due diligence, including review of management accounts, cash flow, burn, liabilities, projections, founder contributions, and funding history.
- Legal / compliance due diligence, including review of incorporation records, statutory filings, licences, key contracts, disputes, and basic regulatory exposure.
- Governance and founder diligence, including cap table review, related-party indicators, disclosures, ownership issues, and red-flag assessment.
- Optional KYC / AML verification support, where specifically requested by RTIH for a given assignment, including review of identity / constitutional documents, beneficial ownership information, AML-related documentary checks, and related compliance support.
- Optional investor- / programme-specific promoter / startup background-check support, where specifically requested by RTIH, including support in relation to credit-history checks, defaulter / caution list checks, and other databases / searches referred to by the relevant investor, lender, or programme framework (including, where applicable, SIDBI-linked requirements).

- For avoidance of doubt, the foregoing optional workstreams shall not be deemed included in the standard due diligence package unless specifically stated in the relevant assignment communication or work order issued by RTIH.
- Preparation of risk-ranked due diligence reports, red-flag memos, condition-precedent notes, and milestone-linked recommendations.
- Follow-up clarification support, closure memos, and committee or board presentation support.
- Urgent or short-turnaround assignments, if specifically requested by RTIH.

5. Eligibility Criteria

- Applicants should be a CA firm, CS firm, law firm, advisory LLP / company, multidisciplinary professional services entity, or other legally valid professional services provider with authority to render the proposed services.
- Minimum 3 years of relevant experience is required.
- Demonstrable experience in startup, MSME, venture, grant-funded, or emerging-company due diligence is strongly preferred.
- Applicants offering legal / compliance due diligence should ensure that any deliverable requiring sign-off under applicable law is handled by a qualified and authorised professional.
- Applicant should be capable of issuing GST invoice where applicable.
- Applicant should not be blacklisted by any government department, PSU, statutory body, or court order at the time of submission.
- Applicant must be willing to comply with RTIH's conflict of interest, confidentiality, data handling, and escalation requirements.

6. Information to be Submitted

- Firm profile, legal constitution, office locations, SPOC details, and service coverage.
- Profile of key professionals proposed for financial, commercial, legal / compliance, governance, or other relevant workstreams.
- Summary of relevant assignments, preferably including startup, venture, incubator, grant-linked, or structured funding due diligence engagements.
- Typical monthly capacity and average turnaround times for standard and urgent assignments.

- Approach note on due diligence methodology, red-flag framework, reporting format, quality review, and conflict checks.
- Indicative sectors of strength and any exclusions / limitations in service coverage.

7. Submission Structure and Method

Applications shall be submitted through the RTIH Google Form link published on the website. The form and uploads should be structured as follows:

- **Part A – Technical / Capability Submission:** firm profile, registrations, key personnel, relevant experience, due diligence approach, red-flag methodology, turnaround time, conflict-management approach, and relevant uploads.
- **Part B – Commercial Submission:** signed rate card for the minimum service basket, taxes / statutory charges treatment, and any optional or special-case services.

RTIH may review technical suitability first and may compare commercial submissions among firms considered suitable for empanelment. This separation is for screening convenience and does not require a formal two-envelope tender process.

All uploaded files should clearly identify the applicant firm and document type in the filename (for example: FirmName_TechnicalProfile.pdf, FirmName_CommercialRateCard.pdf, FirmName_Declaration.pdf).

Commercial Schedule

All quotes shall clearly separate professional fees from statutory / government fees, taxes, travel, specialist third-party costs, or other out-of-pocket expenses.

S No	Service Item	Unit for Quote	Quote Required
D1	Commercial / business due diligence	Per startup	Mandatory
D2	Financial due diligence	Per startup	Mandatory
D3	Legal / compliance due diligence	Per startup	Mandatory
D4	Governance / founder / cap table red-flag review	Per startup	Mandatory

S No	Service Item	Unit for Quote	Quote Required
D4A	KYC / AML verification support	Per startup / assignment	Mandatory or enter 0
D4B	Investor / programme-specific promoter / startup background-check support (including credit history, defaulter / caution list(s), and other databases / searches, where requested)	Per startup / assignment	Mandatory or enter 0
D5	Integrated due diligence package (D1 to D4 combined), excluding D4A/ D4B	Per startup	Mandatory
D6	Condition-precedent / milestone-linked disbursement note	Per assignment	Mandatory
D7	Committee / board presentation or meeting support	Per meeting / assignment	Mandatory
D8	Urgent assignment surcharge, if any	Per assignment	Mandatory or enter 0
D9	Optional additional services proposed by bidder	Specify unit	Optional

Submission Checklist

Document / Input	Mandatory	Remarks
Part A - Firm profile and contact details	Yes	In Google Form / uploaded profile deck
Part A - Registration proof and profile of key professionals	Yes	Membership / registration details as applicable
Part A - Relevant experience note / client examples	Yes	Non-confidential examples are sufficient
Part A - Due diligence methodology and red-flag approach note	Yes	1-4 pages recommended
Part A - Conflict of interest and no-blacklisting declaration	Yes	Signed on letterhead

Document / Input	Mandatory	Remarks
Part B – Signed and stamped commercial rate card	Yes	Professional fee separate from taxes / expenses
Part B – Special-case pricing sheet, if any	No	Optional but recommended
Public listing consent and logo upload	No	Only if the bidder wants RTIH to showcase the firm publicly

8. Evaluation Approach

- Eligibility and completeness of submission.
- Depth and relevance of due diligence experience, especially in startup, MSME, or emerging-company contexts.
- Breadth of service coverage and ability to deliver integrated or multi-workstream diligence.
- Quality of team, methodology, independence, conflict-management, and review safeguards.
- Turnaround commitments, responsiveness, and commercial reasonableness.

9. Optional Public Listing of Empanelled Firms

RTIH may choose to showcase consenting empanelled firms on its website, decks, or ecosystem materials for discoverability. Applicants may opt in separately for such listing.

- The bidder may provide firm logo, website / LinkedIn link, office locations, and a short public profile for such listing.
- Public display by RTIH shall be optional and subject to explicit bidder consent.
- Such listing shall not amount to endorsement, ranking, preferred partner status, exclusivity, or guarantee of work allocation.



10. Key Terms & General Provisions

Audit and Record Retention

The empanelled firm shall retain all working papers and records for a minimum of five (5) years and shall provide access to RTIH for audit upon reasonable notice.

Proposal Validity

All submissions made in response to this RFE shall remain valid and binding for a period of 90 days from the date of submission, unless a longer validity is expressly stated by the applicant.

Applications received after any administrative quarterly review cut-off may be taken up in the subsequent review cycle, without creating any right in favour of the applicant for consideration in a particular cycle.

Nature of Empanelment and No Work Guarantee

This RFE is being issued for the purpose of non-exclusive empanelment of suitable professional firms. Empanelment shall not create any exclusive right, preferred status, minimum business assurance, or guaranteed work allocation in favour of any empanelled firm.

Empanelment Period

Unless otherwise specified by RTIH, empanelment under this RFE shall remain valid for a period of two (2) years from the date of empanelment, unless extended, suspended, or terminated earlier by RTIH.

Work Allocation and Confirmation of Capacity

RTIH may allocate assignments individually or in batches. Before issuing any specific assignment, RTIH may seek confirmation of availability, independence, workstream coverage, acceptance of timelines, and applicability of quoted rates.

Technical and Commercial Review

RTIH may assess technical suitability first and may compare commercial submissions among firms considered suitable for empanelment. RTIH is not bound to adopt a lowest-price-only approach.

Confidentiality

Applicants and empanelled firms shall treat all non-public information, documents, startup data, contracts, financial records, founder information, and transaction materials shared by RTIH in connection with this RFE or any assignment as confidential and shall not disclose or use the same except for the relevant engagement.

Data Protection

The empanelled firm shall comply with all applicable data protection laws in India, including the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.

The firm shall:

- process personal data only for the purpose of the assignment;
- not transfer or store data outside India without prior written consent of RTIH;
- implement appropriate security safeguards;
- notify RTIH of any data breach within 48 hours of becoming aware.

Information Disclaimer

RTIH does not warrant the completeness or accuracy of any information provided by startups or third parties.

The empanelled firm shall independently assess and validate information to the extent reasonably possible within scope.

Conflict of Interest

Applicants must disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest, including any personal, professional, financial, advisory, investor, founder, or counterparty relationship that may impair, or appear to impair, their independence or objectivity in relation to RTIH or any startup / process under review.

The empanelled firm shall not undertake any assignment where a conflict exists or may reasonably be expected to arise.

RTIH reserves the right to require recusal, impose conditions, or reassign the work.

The firm shall provide a specific independence confirmation for each assignment.

Compliance with Applicable Law and Professional Standards

Each applicant shall be solely responsible for ensuring that its participation and any services proposed or rendered pursuant to this RFE are fully compliant with all applicable laws, regulations, and professional conduct requirements.

Accuracy of Information / Misrepresentation

If at any stage an applicant is found to have misrepresented facts, concealed material information, submitted false documents, or otherwise acted in a fraudulent, corrupt, or unfair manner, RTIH may reject the application, cancel empanelment, withdraw any work allocation, or take such other action as it deems appropriate, without liability.

Subcontracting

No empanelled firm shall subcontract the whole or any material part of an assignment issued by RTIH without the prior written approval of RTIH. Where such approval is granted, the empanelled firm shall remain fully responsible for quality, timeliness, compliance, confidentiality, and conduct of the services.

Indemnity

The empanelled firm shall indemnify, defend, and hold harmless RTIH, its officers, employees, and partner institutions from and against losses, claims, damages, penalties, costs, or expenses arising out of professional negligence, breach of confidentiality, non-compliance with applicable law, or misconduct by the firm or its personnel, third-party claims arising from reliance on due diligence outputs, regulatory or compliance actions linked to deficient diligence, losses arising directly or indirectly from services rendered.

This obligation shall survive termination.

Governing Law and Jurisdiction

This RFE and any empanelment arising from it shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of India. Courts at Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh shall have exclusive jurisdiction.

Non-Binding Nature of RFE

No binding relationship, contractual obligation, or enforceable rights shall arise from this RFE or empanelment unless and until a separate written work order or engagement letter is issued by RTIH.

Confidentiality

The empanelled firm shall use all confidential information strictly for the purpose of the relevant assignment and shall not reuse, analyse, benchmark, or indirectly utilise such information for any other client, internal database, or commercial purpose.

The confidentiality obligation shall survive for a period of five (5) years from the date of disclosure.

The firm shall implement reasonable technical and organisational safeguards to protect such information.

RTIH shall be entitled to seek injunctive relief in the event of breach.

Reliance and use of DD Reports

Due diligence reports and outputs are prepared solely for RTIH's internal use unless expressly agreed otherwise.

No third party may rely on such outputs without prior written consent of RTIH.

Annexure 1: Minimum Scope Inclusions for Mandatory Commercial Items

For purposes of commercial comparison, the quoted professional fees for the mandatory commercial items under the Commercial Schedule shall, at a minimum, include the activities listed below. Unless expressly stated otherwise, quoted professional fees under this Annexure shall not include taxes, travel, specialist third-party costs, or other out-of-pocket expenses.

D1. Commercial / business due diligence must include:

- review of the startup's business summary, customer / market information, traction evidence, and information pack made available for the assignment
- assessment of business model, key assumptions, milestones, and use of funds, to the extent relevant
- preparation of a draft commercial review note or section of the integrated due diligence report
- one round of routine clarification / revision based on comments received from RTIH

D2. Financial due diligence must include:

- review of basic financial information, cash flow / burn data, funding history, liabilities, and related records made available for the assignment
- identification of material gaps, inconsistencies, or red flags apparent from the records shared
- preparation of a draft financial review note or section of the integrated due diligence report
- one round of routine clarification / revision based on comments received from RTIH

D3. Legal / compliance due diligence must include:

- review of the basic incorporation records, statutory filing status, licences, and key contracts shared for the assignment
- identification of material legal or compliance red flags apparent from the records shared
- preparation of a draft legal / compliance review note or section of the integrated due diligence report
- one round of routine clarification / revision based on comments received from RTIH

D4. Governance / founder / cap table red-flag review must include:

- review of shareholding / cap table records, founder declarations, related-party indicators, and ownership disclosures shared for the assignment
- identification of material governance, disclosure, or ownership red flags apparent from the records shared

D4A. KYC / AML verification support or background-check support must include:

- review of KYC / constitutional / identity documents of the startup and relevant founders / promoters / authorised signatories, where provided for the assignment
- review of beneficial ownership / control information, where relevant
- identification of documentary gaps, inconsistencies, or red flags apparent from the records shared
- preparation of a short KYC / AML status note, exception note, or pending-items list, as applicable
- one round of routine clarification / revision based on comments received from RTIH

The empanelled firm shall not be responsible for:

- undisclosed or deliberately concealed information, provided that the firm has exercised reasonable professional diligence to identify inconsistencies or red flags;
- limitations or inaccuracies inherent in third-party databases, provided that the firm has used reputable sources and applied reasonable verification checks;
- information not made available within the assignment scope, unless such information gaps ought reasonably to have been identified and flagged by the firm during the course of the diligence.

D4B. Investor / programme-specific promoter / startup background-check support must include:

- support in relation to investor- / programme-specific checks specifically requested by RTIH, including checks relating to promoter / startup credit history, appearance in defaulter / caution list(s), and other databases / searches referred to by the relevant investor / lender / programme
- identification of material exceptions / adverse findings apparent from the records or search results shared / obtained within scope
- preparation of a short background-check note, exception memo, or status summary for RTIH
- one round of routine clarification / revision based on comments received from RTIH

D5. Integrated due diligence package (D1 to D4 combined) must include:

- consolidated report structure with risk categorisation such as green / amber / red or equivalent

- executive summary and recommendation / caution note suitable for committee consideration
- for avoidance of doubt, D4A and D4B shall be included only if specifically requested in the assignment

D6. Condition-precedent / milestone-linked disbursal note must include:

- summary of key conditions to be completed before disbursal or next-stage support
- clear statement of documentary or compliance cures required, where relevant

D7. Committee / board presentation or meeting support must include:

- participation in one internal presentation / clarification meeting related to the assignment
- response to routine questions on findings, red flags, and recommendations

Annexure 2: Indicative Document Responsibility Matrix

- **Startup / relevant entity:** provides statutory documents, licences, contracts, financial records, founder / ownership information, and other supporting information required for the relevant assignment and **where applicable**, KYC / identity / bank / beneficial ownership documents and such further materials as may be required for any assignment-specific KYC / AML or investor- / programme-specific background checks..
- **Empanelled firm:** reviews completeness of information, identifies gaps, undertakes the due diligence within scope, prepares the deliverable set, and provides status updates and clarifications, and **where specifically included in scope**, undertakes / supports KYC / AML verification and/or investor- / programme-specific background-check workstreams..
- **RTIH:** facilitates coordination, shares process context and required scope, monitors status for RTIH-routed matters, and supports escalation where required.